

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI)

1Q25 Earnings Review: Decent results, though NIM will remain a focus

Buy

OCBC.SI 12m Price Target: **S\$18.30** Price: **S\$16.23** Upside: **12.8%**

OCBC posted 1Q25 net profit of S\$1,883mn, -5% yoy/ +12% qoq, inline with GSe (see [First Take: 1Q25 inline as robust non-NII offsets weaker NIM; 2025 guidance intact](#)). Questions at the analyst briefing centered around margin outlook and asset quality. OCBC noted that with 1Q25 exit NIM of 2.03% and assumption of 3 Fed rate cuts in 2025, the bank still holds on to NIM guidance of around 2% for 2025, as the bank expects to offset loan yield pressure with lower funding cost in the coming quarters. The bank saw more room to manage on funding as it has completed its strategic allocation of investment assets in 1Q25. On asset quality, OCBC noted it is under control with only 3% of portfolio exposure to first order impact from US tariffs and the bank considered provision coverage as sufficient with total NPL coverage at 162% and GP to performing loan coverage at 0.9%.

Overall, we view it as a decent set of results with profitability holding up and intact asset quality, despite the contraction in NIM. We will keep monitoring the bank performance or any changes in the macro environment. We remain Buy on OCBC. Post results, we revise down our 2025E-27E net income estimates by 1.5%/2.2%/1.1% to S\$6,976mn /S\$7,055mn /S\$7,532mn, as we bake in the lower NIM in 1Q25, and higher credit cost, partly offset by higher non-NII and lower opex. Our 12-m 2-stage DDM-based target price is unchanged at S\$18.3.

Other key highlights:

- **Maintain 2025 NIM guidance at around 2.0%.** 1Q25 NIM was down 11bps qoq to 2.04% with exit NIM of 2.03%, due to the fast pass through into SORA and HIBOR from Fed rate cuts. With that said, OCBC expects to maintain 2025 NIM at around 2.0% based on the assumption of 3 Fed cuts in 2025. The bank

Melissa Kuang, CFA

+65-6889-2869 | melissa.kuang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

Olivia Shi

+852-29781945 | olivia.shi@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

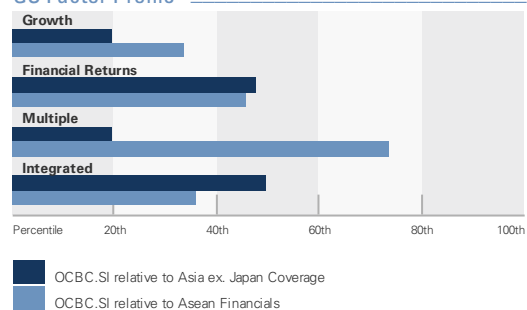
Key Data

Market cap: S\$72.7bn / \$56.1bn
3m ADTV: S\$132.1mn / \$99.3mn
Singapore
Asean Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	7,587.0	6,976.2	7,054.6	7,531.6
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	7,587.0	7,079.3	7,212.6	7,618.3
EPS (S\$) New	1.68	1.56	1.57	1.68
EPS (S\$) Old	1.68	1.58	1.61	1.70
EPS growth (%)	8.1	(7.4)	1.1	6.8
P/E (X)	8.6	10.4	10.3	9.7
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
Price/PPOP (X)	8.3	8.9	8.9	8.4
Dividend yield (%)	7.0	5.8	5.9	6.3
	3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
EPS (S\$)	0.42	0.40	0.38	0.35

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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Buy

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI)

Rating since May 2, 2023

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.6	10.4	10.3	9.7
Price/PPOP (X)	8.3	8.9	8.9	8.4
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	7.0	5.8	5.9	6.3
Div. payout ratio (%)	60.1	60.0	60.1	60.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	8.9	3.5	4.7	5.8
Total revenue growth	7.2	(2.9)	0.8	4.7
Op. profit growth	5.4	(6.1)	0.0	5.9
Net inc growth	8.1	(8.1)	1.1	6.8
EPS growth	8.1	(7.4)	1.1	6.8
DPS growth	23.2	(7.5)	2.0	6.6

Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0
NPL ratio (%)	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.3	1.2	1.3	1.3
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	45.2	34.1	34.8	35.2
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	144.0	132.2	132.2	131.4

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	17.8	17.8	17.8	18.3

Price Performance



Source: FactSet. Price as of 9 May 2025 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	9,755.0	9,255.6	9,013.9	9,215.8
Net fees	1,970.0	2,211.1	2,493.1	2,823.6
Treasury income	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	2,748.0	2,587.8	2,665.7	2,796.1
Total revenue	14,473.0	14,054.5	14,172.7	14,835.5
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,837.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(1,905.0)	(5,856.8)	(5,974.0)	(6,153.2)
Pre-provision op. profit	8,731.0	8,197.7	8,198.7	8,682.3
Provision for loans	(561.0)	(810.3)	(805.9)	(840.9)
Total provision expense	(690.0)	(810.3)	(805.9)	(840.9)
Income/(loss) from associates	994.0	1,080.5	1,144.2	1,270.1
Pre-tax profit	8,976.0	8,408.8	8,478.0	9,052.5
Provision for taxes	(1,228.0)	(1,283.5)	(1,271.7)	(1,357.9)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	7,587.0	6,976.2	7,054.6	7,531.6
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	7,587.0	6,976.2	7,054.6	7,531.6
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	1.68	1.56	1.59	1.69
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	1.68	1.56	1.57	1.68
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	4,515.0	4,481.3	4,481.3	4,481.3
Avg. yield on loans (%)	5.1	4.8	4.8	4.7
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.8	4.2	3.9	3.8
Cost of fund (%)	3.0	2.6	2.4	2.3
Net interest margin (%)	2.1	1.9	1.7	1.7

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	68,358.0	70,488.4	73,347.0	76,738.8
Domestic non-mortgages	32,679.0	33,697.4	35,064.0	36,685.5
Domestic commercial lending	196,461.0	202,583.7	210,799.5	220,547.5
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	319,166.0	329,112.9	342,460.0	358,296.3
Total NPLs, gross	2,827.0	3,079.7	3,307.3	3,567.7
Total loan loss reserve	4,070.0	4,070.0	4,372.2	4,687.5
Net customer loans & advances	315,096.0	325,217.9	338,262.7	353,783.8
Other interest earning assets	77,852.0	79,526.5	80,476.3	81,452.2
Interest earning assets	484,270.0	506,647.9	528,314.8	548,118.4
Other non-int. earning assets	140,780.0	147,241.5	153,551.4	160,248.8
Total assets	625,050.0	653,889.4	681,866.1	708,367.2
Risk weighted assets	236,288.0	242,048.9	250,567.7	258,211.9
CASA deposits	190,753.0	205,059.5	215,312.4	223,924.9
Non-CASA deposits	199,934.0	211,604.4	221,401.9	229,854.9
Customer deposits	390,687.0	416,663.9	436,714.4	453,779.9
Other paying liabilities	281.0	281.0	281.0	281.0
Other liabilities	27,652.0	22,980.8	22,980.8	22,980.8
Total liabilities	564,670.0	591,122.3	616,576.7	639,316.3
Total shareholders' equity	60,380.0	62,767.2	65,289.5	69,051.0
Total liabilities & equity	625,050.0	653,889.4	681,866.1	708,367.2
BVPS (\$\$)	12.76	13.21	13.83	14.64
RWA/assets (%)	37.8	37.0	36.7	36.5

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	7.6	3.2	4.0	4.6
Net interest margin (%)	2.1	1.9	1.7	1.7
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	39.3	41.3	41.7	41.1
Tax rate (%)	13.7	15.3	15.0	15.0
CASA ratio (%)	48.8	49.2	49.3	49.3
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	80.7	78.1	77.5	78.0

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.4	2.2	2.1	2.1
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.0	0.9	0.9	0.9
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.4	1.3	1.2	1.2
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.5	1.3	1.3	1.3
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.3	1.1	1.1	1.1
Leverage (X)	10.4	10.4	10.4	10.3
ROE (%)	13.7	11.9	11.7	11.9
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	13.1	11.3	11.0	11.2

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

expects improvement of funding cost from lower deposit cost and other active management to offset pressure on the loan yield. Moreover, OCBC mentioned it will have more room to maneuver on the liability side going forward to trim down expensive funding, as the bank has completed strategic allocation into investment securities in 1Q25. Though the bank does see downside risk to guidance if Fed cuts or pass through is higher than expected. We forecast NIM of 1.99% for 2025, as we bake in 5 Fed rate cuts in 2025.

- **Targets mid-single digit loan growth.** OCBC delivered 1%qoq/ 7% yoy loan growth in 1Q25, driven by mortgages and corporate loans, mainly in transportation, storage and telecommunication industries. The bank does see headwinds from US tariffs, but maintains loan growth guidance unchanged, on the back of the customer base that has a lot of focus in domestic business such as property, data centers, renewable energy, as well as the strong pipeline seen at the moment. We forecast loan growth of 3% for the year.
- **Robust momentum in wealth management.** OCBC received S\$5bn net new money inflow in 1Q25, bringing AUM to a record high of S\$306bn. Investment asset contribution to AUM increased to 60% and OCBC noticed there is some reposition in Apr but largely stable. We forecast fee income growth of 12% for 2025.
- **Asset quality is under control.** OCBC notes that only 3% of its portfolio has exposure to the first order impact from US tariffs, i.e. the industries with higher exposure to the US and China, such as manufacturing, international logistics, trade of raw materials etc. The bank is comfortable with its current provision level, with total NPL coverage at 162% and GP to performing loan coverage at 0.9%. The bank will remain vigilant on macro conditions, but does not see the necessity to increase GP at this moment. On CRE risk, OCBC noted there is no material changes and would not be a drag on NPL. Credit cost guidance is unchanged at 20-25bps for 2025, and we forecast 2025 credit cost of 25bps.

Key risks include: (-) Sudden or sharper-than-expected FED cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; and (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity. Remain Buy.

Exhibit 1: OCBC 1Q25 Earnings Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)						Actual vs. Est			
	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q25E	(%)
Net Interest Income	2,437	2,430	2,433	2,455	2,345	(4)	(4)	2,461	(5)
Fee & Commission	479	466	508	517	546	14	6	532	3
Insurance Income	289	294	233	101	306	6	203	235	30
Other Non-Interest Income	421	439	628	343	458	9	34	373	23
Non-Interest Income	1,189	1,199	1,369	961	1,310	10	36	1,140	15
Operating Income	3,626	3,629	3,802	3,416	3,655	1	7	3,601	2
Operating Expenses	(1,346)	(1,373)	(1,463)	(1,560)	(1,415)	5	(9)	(1,454)	(3)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,280	2,256	2,339	1,856	2,240	(2)	21	2,147	4
Loan Loss Provisions	(169)	(144)	(169)	(208)	(212)	25	2	(192)	10
Pre-tax Profit	2,343	2,332	2,415	1,887	2,297	(2)	22	2,202	4
Net Profit	1,982	1,944	1,974	1,687	1,883	(5)	12	1,834	3
Balance sheet (\$\$mn)									
Assets	597,177	598,890	602,006	625,050	636,255	7	2	632,962	1
Gross Loans	301,000	303,983	305,000	319,166	322,000	7	1	321,271	0
Customer Deposits	369,841	369,835	369,280	390,687	402,732	9	3	395,183	2
CAMEL Ratios (%)									
Core Tier 1	16.2	15.5	15.6	15.3	15.5			16.0	
NPL Ratio	0.98	0.93	0.90	0.89	0.90			0.90	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	23	19	22	27	26			24	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.27	2.20	2.18	2.15	2.04			2.10	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	37.1	37.8	38.5	45.7	38.7			40.4	
Loan-to-Deposits	81.4	82.2	82.6	81.7	80.0			81.3	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Reg AC

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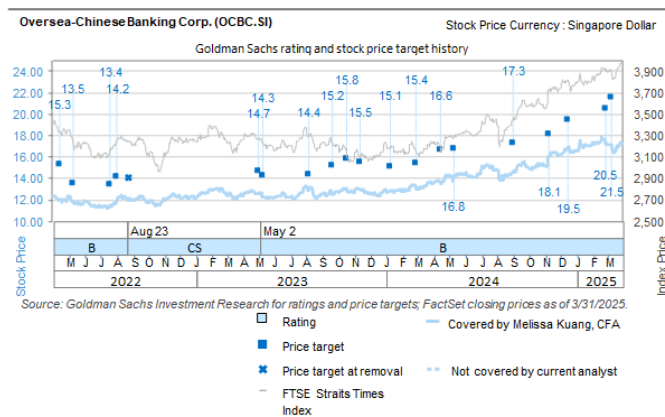
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